

Trust Commerce

**A Social E-commerce & Escrow-Based Payment Platform
for Safe Online Buying & Selling or any contract**

Project Report

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1. Executive Summary

Trust Commerce is an escrow-based e-commerce social media and payment platform designed to solve the trust deficit, payment complexity of SSL or existing and product showcasing website that plagues online buying and selling. Buyers often pay for products they never fully receive, while sellers ship goods to buyers who later refuse to pay. This mutual distrust shrinks the online market for everyone. Trust Commerce solves this by providing sellers with a showcasing website where they can add products directly to their own pages, combined with an escrow system ensuring no one can commit fraud. The platform holds a buyer's payment in escrow until the buyer confirms satisfactory delivery, with a dedicated review team resolving any disputes fairly. The platform also functions as a full payment gateway, letting sellers receive and withdraw funds through bKash, Nagad, Rocket, Upay, cards, and bank transfers

2. Problem Statement

Online commerce in Bangladesh and similar markets suffers from a two-sided trust problem:

- Buyers pay upfront and risk receiving a wrong, damaged, or missing product with no reliable way to get their money back.
- Sellers ship products or complete agreed work, then risk buyers falsely claiming non-delivery or simply refusing to pay.
- There is no neutral, trusted third party to mediate these disputes quickly and fairly.
- The SSL or other online payment needs complex verification
- The new seller cannot create website or payment account

As a result, many potential buyers avoid shopping online altogether, and honest sellers lose sales to fear and reputation damage caused by a small number of bad actors on both sides. This creates a net loss of economic activity for the entire online marketplace ecosystem.

3. Proposed Solution

TrustCommerce acts as a trusted middleman between buyers and sellers for any transaction, so buyer can pay with any payment method and seller can withdraw their fund, seller can add their product here so they do not need additional website complexity — physical products, digital goods, services, freelance contracts, or even informal agreements and bets. The core mechanism is an escrow wallet system with social ecommerce:

1. The seller creates a profile and lists a product, service, or agreement with a price and terms.
2. The buyer agrees to the terms and pays the amount into TrustCommerce's escrow wallet — not directly to the seller.
3. The seller delivers the product or fulfills the agreement.
4. The buyer confirms whether they received what was promised.
5. If confirmed, funds are released to the seller automatically.
6. If the buyer disputes it, TrustCommerce's review team investigates evidence (chat logs, delivery proof, photos, tracking data) and awards the funds to the rightful party.

7. Sellers can withdraw available earnings at any time via bKash, Nagad, Rocket, Upay, card, or bank transfer.

4. Target Audience

- Individual online buyers and sellers, including Facebook/Instagram-based shops
- Small and medium e-commerce businesses without their own trust or escrow infrastructure
- Peer-to-peer sellers of used goods and local classifieds
- Freelancers and clients needing secure milestone-based contract payments
- Individuals needing a neutral third party to hold funds for informal agreements or bets

5. Business Model

TrustCommerce generates revenue through multiple complementary streams:

Revenue Stream	Description
Transaction Fee	A small percentage (2–5%) charged per completed escrow transaction, paid by the seller, buyer, or split between both.
Withdrawal Fee	A small fee applied when sellers cash out earnings to bKash, Nagad, Rocket, Upay, bank, or card.
Premium Seller Accounts	Subscription plans offering verified badges, lower transaction fees, and priority dispute resolution.
Escrow-as-a-Service (API)	Licensing TrustCommerce's escrow engine to other e-commerce platforms so they can embed trust and payment protection into their own checkout flow.
Priority Dispute Resolution	Optional fee for buyers or sellers who want expedited case review.

6. Key Features

- Escrow wallet system with automated hold-and-release logic
- Buyer and seller profiles with a reputation/rating system
- Internal dispute-resolution dashboard for the review team
- Multi-channel payout integration: bKash, Nagad, Rocket, Upay, cards, and banks
- Support for flexible use cases: product sales, service contracts, and informal agreements
- In-platform chat and evidence upload system to support fair dispute resolution

7. Market Opportunity

Online commerce continues to grow rapidly, but trust remains one of the biggest barriers to adoption in markets where formal buyer/seller protection is weak. By directly addressing this gap, TrustCommerce can recover buyers who have stopped shopping online due to past fraud, and recover sellers who have lost sales to

non-paying buyers. Additionally, licensing the escrow engine to other platforms opens a scalable B2B revenue channel beyond the core marketplace.

8. Challenges & Risk Mitigation

Challenge	Mitigation Approach
Manual dispute review may not scale	Introduce tiered review (automated evidence checks for simple cases, human review for complex ones) as volume grows.
Regulatory compliance for holding customer funds	Partner with licensed payment aggregators and MFS providers; pursue required financial licensing early.
Collusion or fake disputes between bad-faith buyers and sellers	Build a reputation/rating system and pattern-detection to flag suspicious repeat behavior.
Cash flow management while holding escrow funds	Maintain segregated escrow accounts and conservative float management practices.

9. Future Roadmap

- Phase 1: Launch core escrow marketplace with manual dispute resolution
- Phase 2: Integrate all major mobile financial services and card/bank payment rails
- Phase 3: Introduce seller reputation scoring and semi-automated dispute triage
- Phase 4: Launch Escrow-as-a-Service API for third-party e-commerce platforms
- Phase 5: Expand to regional markets with similar trust gaps in online commerce

10. Conclusion

TrustCommerce directly addresses a real and widespread problem: the lack of trust between buyers and sellers in online commerce. By combining an escrow payment system, flexible marketplace functionality, and a fair dispute-resolution process, TrustCommerce can restore confidence in online transactions for both sides, grow the overall online marketplace, and build a sustainable, scalable fintech business.